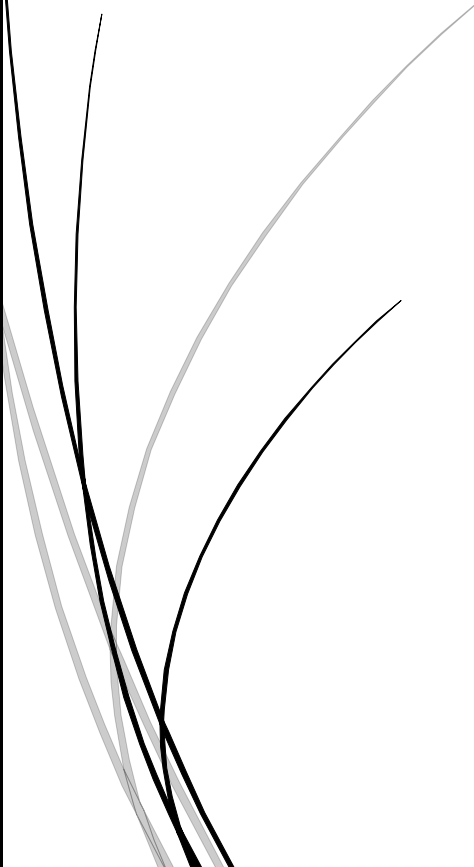




12/7/2025

Semester Project

Management Interview — Ghazi
Barotha Taraqiyati Idara (GBTI)

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1. Eman Ahmad (FA25-BBD-037)
 2. Yumna Gul (FA25-BBD-173)
 3. Sehrish Naz (FA25-BBD-140)
 4. Ayesha Malik (FA25-BBD-028)
 5. Saroush Mujeeb (FA25-BBD-139)
 6. Sudais Ahmad (FA25-BBD-147)



Introduction

This report presents an in-depth analysis of a management interview conducted with **Mr. Muhammad Ishtiaq**, the **Chief Financial Officer (CFO)** of the **Ghazi Barotha Taraqiati Idara (GBTI)**. GBTI operates in the nonprofit development sector, primarily supporting rural communities affected by the Ghazi Barotha Hydropower Project. The organization focuses on microfinance, community mobilization, infrastructure development, women empowerment, education, and rural development initiatives.

The purpose of this report is to explore how management principles function within a development of organization, particularly through the lens of a senior financial manager. The interview aims to connect academic management theories—such as planning, organizing, leading, and controlling—with real-world practices, challenges, ethical responsibilities, and decision-making.

Interview Summary

Background of GBTI

GBTI was founded in 1995 with support from WAPDA and guidance from social development specialist Shoaib Sultan Khan. The institute operates as a **Section 42 company** registered with the **SECP** and licensed as a **Non-Banking Microfinance Company**. Its mission revolves around poverty alleviation, capacity-building, and integrated rural development.

Core Functions

- Organizing communities into Cos (Community Level Organization), Vos (Village Organization), and LSOs (Union Council Level Local Support Organization)
- Supporting microfinance and community savings
- Assisting with legal, social, and economic development
- Building skills through vocational training
- Implementing water supply, sanitation, and infrastructure projects
- Encouraging community-led planning

Achievements

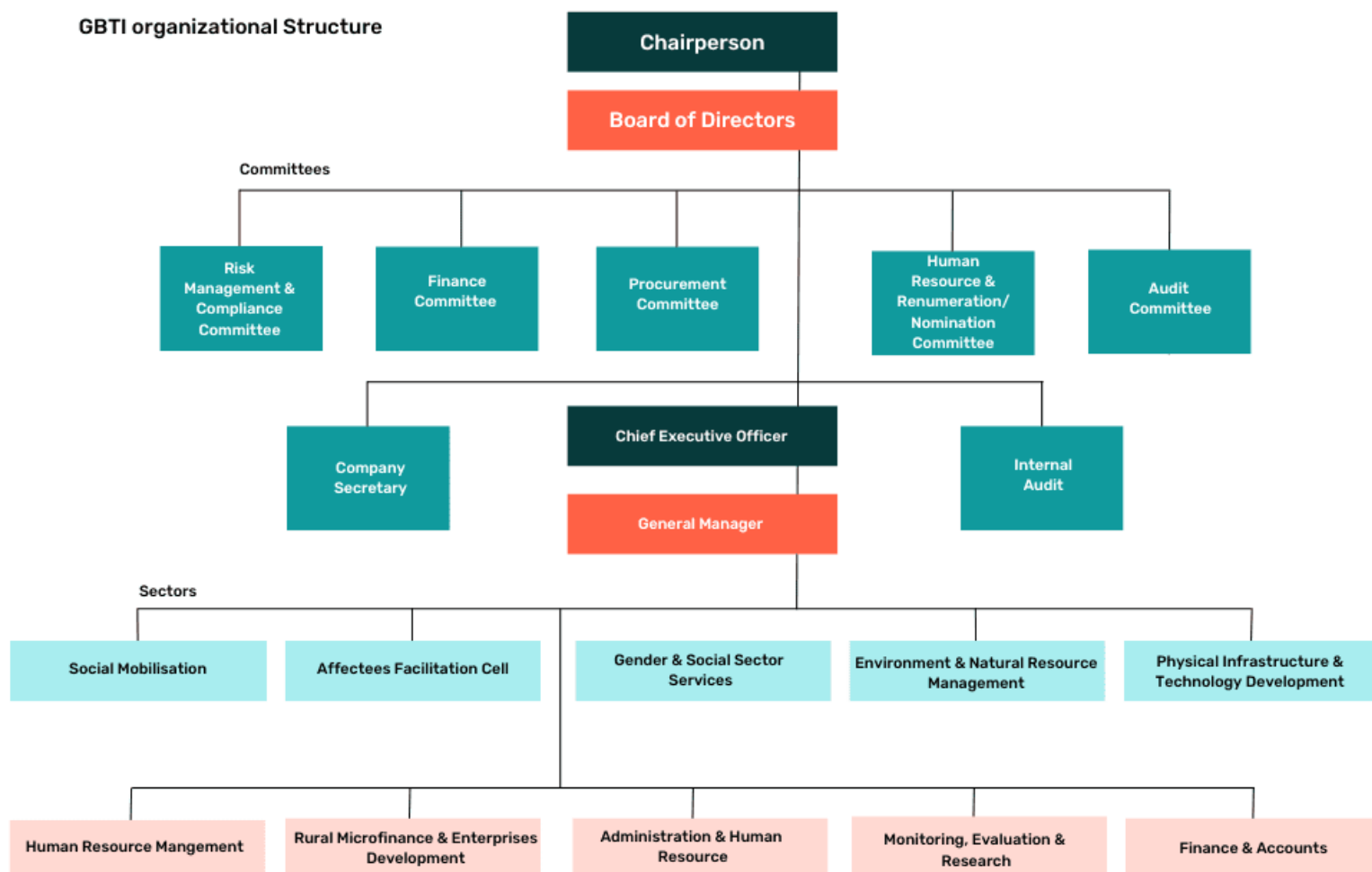
- 48,771 households mobilized
- 3,644 COs, 112 VOs, 16 LSOs formed
- Over Rs. 16.7 million saved collectively



- Continuous projects in education, water, sanitation, agriculture, and health

Organizational Structure of GBTI

GBTI organizational Structure



Manager Interview Summary

Manager Details

- **Name:** Mr. Muhammad Ishtiaq
- **Designation:** Chief Financial Officer (CFO)



- **Department:** Finance and Compliance
- **Sector:** Nonprofit Development / Microfinance

The CFO oversees financial operations, budgeting, donor funding, investment funds, loan management, inflation adjustments, and regulatory compliance.

Management Challenges Faced

The CFO highlighted that real-life management is more unpredictable and demanding than theory. The main challenges include:

- Limited financial resources versus large community needs
- Donor dependency and changing donor priorities
- Inflation affecting project costs and staff salaries
- Balancing transparency with speed of operations
- Maintaining compliance with SECP (Security and Exchange Commission of Pakistan) and audit requirements
- Handling expectations from communities, donors, and staff simultaneously

He explained that the rural development sector requires constant problem-solving and adapting plans according to on-ground realities.

Decision-Making Approach

According to the CFO, good decision-making requires:

- Understanding field conditions
- Reviewing previous data
- Assessing risks before finalizing budgets
- Consulting field teams and accounting staff
- Staying calm under pressure
- Prioritizing community needs
- Maintaining transparency



He emphasized that financial decisions must be backed by documents, evidence, and compliance rules because GBTI handles donor funds.

Ethics and Promoting Ethical Behavior

Ethical performance is essential for a nonprofit. GBTI encourages this through:

- Documented financial controls
- Regular audits
- Adherence to SECP regulations
- Monitoring donor fund utilization
- Training staff on proper conduct
- Ensuring equal treatment of employees
- Community accountability—villagers report unethical behavior

The CFO added that ethical behavior earns donor trust and protects the organization's reputation.

Four Functions of Management at GBTI

Planning

- Needs are identified through village-level consultations
- Resource availability is reviewed
- Annual and quarterly budgets are prepared
- Priorities are set based on urgency (education, sanitation, water, etc.)
- Donor funding windows guide project focus

Organizing

- Field teams are assigned to specific villages
- Finance, monitoring, and program units coordinate
- Community leaders are engaged
- Communication channels are established between COs, VOs, LSOs, and headquarters



Leading

- Managers motivate staff through mission-driven work
- Recognition, appreciation, and exposure visits encourage performance
- Managers model ethical behavior and professionalism
- Staff is guided through open communication and supportive supervision

Controlling

- Monthly financial reviews
 - Project progress tracking
 - Community feedback meetings
 - Quarterly donor reporting
 - Ensuring loan recovery rates remain stable
 - Comparing targets with actual performance
-

Goal Setting and Prioritization

The CFO explained that goals are set using a **village-to-headquarters model**:

1. Field teams identify needs with community organizations
2. Issues are ranked based on urgency
3. Management checks available funds
4. Goals are set for each quarter
5. Priorities are adjusted if donors release new opportunities
6. Monitoring ensures the set targets are followed

Their goal-setting is always linked with practical reality—not theoretical models—because community needs drive operations.

Motivating Employees

Motivation is built through:

- Annual increments



- Fieldwork exposure
- Training and workshops
- Recognition in meetings
- Opportunities to work on meaningful community projects
- Internal promotions based on performance
- A supportive environment focusing on social impact

Working for rural communities gives employees purpose, which strengthens their motivation.

Delegation Style

Tasks are delegated by:

- Matching assignments to staff skills
- Considering workload
- Assigning experienced workers to sensitive tasks
- Giving autonomy but checking progress
- Providing clear instructions and timelines

The CFO prefers structured delegation where responsibilities are documented and monitored.

Handling Diverse Personalities

GBTI works with staff from different backgrounds. The CFO manages personalities by:

- Adjusting communication according to the individual
- Offering mentorship to juniors
- Respecting senior staff autonomy
- Maintaining a calm and respectful tone
- Building team cooperation through shared goals
- Holding discussions when conflicts appear

This helps keep the workplace stable and cooperative.



Performance Measurement (KPIs)

GBTI's KPIs include:

- Number of COs, VOs, LSOs formed and active
- Community savings
- Loan disbursement and recovery percentages
- Training sessions conducted
- Infrastructure improvements completed
- Community participation
- Staff performance evaluations
- Donor satisfaction and timely reporting

These indicators help managers monitor progress and adjust strategies.

Handling Poor Performance

If performance declines, the CFO:

1. Identifies the cause
2. Offers guidance and support
3. Provides training or mentoring
4. Reassigns tasks if needed
5. Issues warnings for repeated issues

The goal is improvement rather than punishment.

Impact of External Environment

Government Rules

SECP regulations shape financial management and reporting systems.

Example: Increased compliance audits after policy changes.



Donors

Their focus areas influence GBTI's project priorities.

Example: When donors emphasize climate action, GBTI increases plantation drives.

Local Communities

Their acceptance determines project success.

Example: Some communities require additional awareness sessions before involving women in training.

Economy

Inflation increases program costs and impacts salaries.

Example: Fuel price increases limit field visits.

International Trends

Global focus shifts donor funds.

Example: After global emphasis on early childhood education, GBTI received support for ECE centers.

Current GBTI Projects

- Plantation drive in Attock
- Drinking Water Supply Scheme at Government Primary School, Dhok Haji Ahmed
- Construction of toilets in girls' schools
- Boundary wall construction at Government Girls Primary School, Dhok Kisran
- Establishing ECE centers in multiple villages

Advice from the CFO

The CFO advised students to:

- Treat all employees with respect
- Stay disciplined and consistent
- Avoid arrogance
- Improve skills and behavior
- Perform every task responsibly



- Build professionalism and integrity

He reinforced that reputation is built on attitude, not just qualifications.

Key Takeaways

- Management in nonprofit settings is more complex than theory suggests.
 - Effective decision-making requires field understanding, not just data.
 - Ethical systems protect credibility and donor trust.
 - Motivation comes through meaningful work, not only financial incentives.
 - Planning must adapt to ground realities, community needs, and donor cycles.
 - Delegation succeeds when matched with skill and supported by monitoring.
 - External environmental factors shape nearly every project.
 - Respectful leadership creates stronger teams and sustainable programs.
 - The CFO's advice emphasizes behavior and professionalism as essential leadership qualities.
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Conclusion

The interview with the CFO of GBTI provided a practical understanding of how management concepts apply in real organizational settings. The four functions of management—planning, organizing, leading, and controlling—were clearly visible in the way GBTI structures its programs and manages operations. The insights show that effective management is a mix of strategy, ethical behavior, adaptation to external factors, and strong interpersonal skills.

Comparing these observations with class theories helps bridge the gap between academic learning and real-life leadership challenges. This experience highlights that successful management requires continuous learning, humility, and a deep understanding of human behavior and organizational dynamics.